

Emmett Normand

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SUMMARY

Materials Engineering student at Cal Poly, continuing into the Polymers and Coatings master's program, with nine years at iFixit in device testing, teardown, and value recovery. Driven by sustainability and figuring out why things fail.

EDUCATION

California Polytechnic State University <i>M.S. Polymers and Coatings Science (blended BS/MS)</i> <i>B.S. Materials Engineering GPA 3.52 Major GPA 3.79</i>	San Luis Obispo, CA <i>Expected Dec 2028</i> <i>Expected May 2027</i>
• Coursework: Electronic Materials Systems, Structural Materials Systems, Metallurgical Materials Systems, Noncrystalline Materials Systems, Composites Manufacturing, Engineering Test Design & Analysis, Design & Manufacturing, Transport Phenomena, Materials Laboratory II–III, Materials Engineering Analysis • In progress: Materials Thermodynamics & Kinetics, Ceramic & Glass Materials Systems, Materials Selection & Life Cycle, Biotechnology for Sustainable Materials, Advanced Research (CHEM 4401)	
Cuesta College <i>A.S. Engineering (Dec 2024); A.S. Computer Science (Aug 2024)</i>	San Luis Obispo, CA <i>2024</i>

PROJECTS

Flow Battery Senior Project <i>Cal Poly MATE, advisor Dr. Jones</i>	Sep 2026 – Present
• Using a miniaturized table top flow battery to test alternatives to vanadium charge carriers.	
Cal Fire Pigment Change Research <i>Cal Poly MATE, Dr. Sapper</i>	Summer 2026 – Present
• Characterized pigment samples by XRD, DSC, TGA, and SEM to establish baseline crystalline phase, thermal transitions, decomposition behavior, and surface morphology. • Fabricated mock building wall sections with representative coating systems as cone calorimeter specimens for a Cal Fire study on wildfire thermal exposure. • Designed the test matrix to characterize pigment color change as a function of thermal history.	

EXPERIENCE

iFixit <i>Value Reclamations Lead</i>	San Luis Obispo, CA <i>Aug 2017 – Present</i>
• Manage iFixit's device test benches (iPhone, PC, and other consumer electronics) used to validate parts and diagnose returned units. • Built a buyback program that recovers value from damaged components, returning value while diverting hardware from e-waste. • Own the global returns process, coordinating logistics and workflows across international teams. • Lead and mentor a team of 2 across repair, testing, and reclamation.	
The Bicycle Stand <i>Bicycle Mechanic</i>	San Luis Obispo, CA <i>2015 – 2016</i>
• Shimano-certified mechanic performing diagnostics, drivetrain rebuilds, and wheel builds; scoped repairs with customers to fit budget and riding use.	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Characterization: optical microscopy, metallography, tensile and hardness testing, heat treatment, SEM, XRD, DSC, TGA
Fabrication: 3D printing, lathe, mill, MIG and stick welding, composite layup
Electronics: board-level soldering, microsoldering, device teardown and functional test
Software: SolidWorks, Fusion 360, Minitab, Excel, JavaScript, Java, C++
Certifications: Shimano Service Certification; 200-hr Yoga Teacher Training (2020)
Interests: yoga; road, track, and mountain cycling; climbing